भारत सरकार /Government of India
गृह मंत्रालय /Ministry of Home Affairs
भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय
Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India
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No. XII-019/02/2025-Map/19 **Date: 8th September, 2025**

Census of India 2027 – Circular No. 4

Subject: Updating of Base maps for Census 2027

The preparatory works for Census 2027 have commenced with the issuance of the notification on the intent to conduct the Census. This was followed by Circulars 1, 2, and 3 issued by this office. These circulars provide detailed instructions on the methodology for compiling information on all jurisdictional changes that have occurred since Census 2011. They also cover jurisdictional changes that will take place up to 31st December 2025. As an essential part of preparatory work, the updation of existing harmonized geo-spatial data of administrative boundaries pertaining to States/UTs, Districts, Sub-districts, Towns, Wards and Village as per their current jurisdictions are also in progress. This is being done to ensure complete coverage of the country's geographical area without any omission or overlap during Census field operations. The updated geo-referenced administrative boundaries constitute a vital component of the Digital Census, enabling effective field operations and comprehensive monitoring of coverage.

2. This circular provides guidance for updating the latest jurisdictions in the harmonised geo-spatial data of administrative boundaries at all levels i.e., State/UT, District, Sub-district, Town, Ward and Village. It also provides instructions for preparing working maps of Sub-districts and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs). These maps will be used for verification of every Village and Town (with Wards) falling within Sub-districts and ULBs respectively. The updates shall cover all jurisdictional changes that have occurred since 1st January 2010, based on notifications issued by

the concerned State/UT Governments and the subsequent updates incorporated in the Census Master Directory of Villages/Towns by the DCOs. As mentioned in para 1 above, the work of updating geo-spatial data for jurisdictional changes up to 30th June 2025 has already been initiated in the DCOs in accordance with instructions and guidelines issued by this office from time to time. This updating process shall continue, in alignment with Census Circulars 1, 2, and 3, to incorporate all jurisdictional changes already notified, or may be notified by the State/UT Governments, up to 31st December 2025. Special attention shall also be given to Ward boundaries of ULBs, for ensuring consistency with the revised Ward boundary notifications and seamless integration with rural areas to finalize Rural–Urban Frame.

3. Updation of jurisdictional changes:

i. The DCOs shall use the harmonized geo-spatial data of administrative boundaries, as shared by the Map Division, ORGI, for incorporating jurisdictional changes required for Census 2027. The types of jurisdictional changes that require incorporation are detailed in Para 2 of Census Circular No. 1 dated 13th August 2025. It is reiterated that all updates whether for creation of new Districts/Sub-districts/Villages/Towns or modification of existing boundaries shall strictly be carried out using reliable government data sources such as the Survey/Settlement/Revenue/Land Records Departments of the State/UT, Bharat Maps of NIC, Jal Jeevan Mission, PMGSY, etc. The source of data used for effecting changes in the existing geometry shall be mandatorily recorded in the relevant field of the geo-spatial data. No update shall be undertaken without recording the source of data for making such changes.

ii. For the Villages which cannot be identified or demarcated due to technical difficulties, the concerned State/UT authorities may be approached for obtaining the Cadastral/ Khasra maps and boundary for the Village to be marked accordingly.

iii. In cases where boundaries of Villages/Towns are to be created notionally due to the non-availability of reliable data sources, the boundary status shall be recorded as '*Notional*' in the relevant field of the geo-spatial data layer. Such notional boundaries shall be reviewed subsequently for amendments using reliable data sources depending on their availability. Please refer to the

detailed guidelines issued vide letter no. XII-010/21/2023-Map/12 dated 16th July, 2025 (copy enclosed) for updation of harmonised geospatial data and the present circular must be read in accordance with those instructions.

iv. In the event of unresolvable discrepancies or quality issues in the geo-spatial data of administrative boundaries, the DCOs shall liaise with the concerned State/UT Government organizations to obtain accurate and usable boundary data for incorporation.

v. Appropriate classification as per Rural/Urban nomenclature prescribed in Circulars 1 and 2 shall be incorporated in the respective geo-spatial data fields. Depending upon the availability of Census Towns and Out Growth information, the same are also to be updated in the respective field and the MDDS (2011) code of the Village shall be retained in case of Out Growths as unique identifier. Further, the names of Urban Agglomerations shall be updated against their respective constituent units (as per the approved unit list obtained from Census Section of the DCO).

vi. It shall be ensured that the constituent units of Sub-districts and Urban Local Bodies i.e Villages and Wards, respectively, must be accurate and consistent with the Census Master Directory of Villages/Towns with respect to jurisdiction and civic status.

vii. Upon completion of the above updates, the harmonized geo-spatial data of administrative boundaries of the concerned State/UT shall be uploaded to the map portal (https://map.census.gov.in) for further access and use by DCOs and later by Charge Officers. Subsequent updates can be carried out directly on the map service available through the map portal by the respective DCOs.

viii. The DCOs of the States/UTs for which mapping work is being handled by Map Division, ORGI, must share all the notifications and latest 'For-Read' statements with Map Division as soon as possible for timely completion of updation of Geo-spatial database and the final generation of all working maps.

4. Updation of Other layers: All natural features, such as rivers, streams, and reserved forests, must be duly updated in the geo-spatial data layers provided by Map Division. In addition, transportation features, including National and State Highways as well as railway lines (Broad Gauge and Meter Gauge), are to be carefully reviewed and updated in the respective layer based on the latest available information. Particular attention should be given to the accurate depiction of railway

station locations (if available), as well as the correct naming and numbering of National and State Highways.

5. Preparation of working maps for verification: On completion of all updates as detailed above, the working maps for Sub-districts and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs) are to be prepared and shared with DCO-Census Section to enclose with list of Villages/Towns which will be sent to concerned authorities for verification and confirmation. If the DCOs have already generated working maps post issuance of Circular 1 and shared them with the concerned authorities for verification, maps for such Sub-districts/ULBs need not be regenerated. The details to be included in these working maps using the updated geo-spatial data of administrative boundaries are given below.

i. **Sub-district Maps**:

a. Sub-district maps shall be prepared in colour, depicting all Villages/Towns under the jurisdiction as per the symbology given in the sample templates.

b. Maps shall include layers of transportation networks, rivers/streams, and reserved/protected forests.

c. Where the number of Villages/Towns is too high to annotate by name on the Map, then MDDS (2011) codes shall be used. The accompanying list shall include a matching column for these codes. Strict concordance between codes in the list and the map must be ensured.

d. For new Villages/Towns without MDDS (2011) codes, index numbers shall be shown on both the map and the list for ease of reference.

e. Maps shall preferably be printed in A3 size where the number of Villages/Towns is fewer than 50. For larger numbers, bigger page sizes can be used to maintain legibility.

f. Printed copies shall be enclosed with the List of Villages/Towns for submission to concerned authorities. Where communication is through email, PDF versions may be attached. In case of non-availability printing facility (plotters and printers), the printing of maps can be done through external printing facilities.

g. Sample templates (Annexure I) have been enclosed that need to be used to ensure uniformity and execute the map export through Data Driven Page tool for faster generation of maps.

ii. **Urban Local Body maps**: The geo-spatial data of Ward boundaries for ULBs have already been compiled for most of the Statutory Towns, yet these boundaries are liable to frequent changes as per delimitation activities initiated in the respective States/UTs. As these Ward boundaries are compiled from various sources on different occasions, it is important to get these boundaries verified and confirmed by respective ULB authorities. For facilitating this, working maps for all ULBs are to be prepared by depicting the Ward boundaries available with the DCOs. The map are to be prepared as detailed below;

a. Working maps for all ULBs and of each Ward separately shall be prepared in colour by DCOs using the latest Ward boundaries available and overlaid on satellite imagery preferably in A2 size. For all Municipal Corporations and large Towns, the size of the map can be decided as per area and the number of Wards.

b. As the working map is embedded with Satellite imagery, there is no need to add other layers. However, the Village boundaries layer (with their name/2011 MDDS codes) must be overlaid for providing references to the surrounding Villages that are sharing the boundary with respective ULBs.

c. Sample templates (Annexure II & III) have been prepared that need to be used to ensure uniformity and execute the map export through Data Driven Page tool for faster generation of maps.

d. Printed copies shall be enclosed with the letter for submission to concerned authorities. Where communication is through email, PDF versions may be attached. In case of non-availability printing facility (plotters and printers), the printing of maps need to be done through external printing facilities.

e. The ULBs shall be requested to verify and confirm the number of Wards, their extent, and the inclusion of all surrounding areas within the ULB.

f. Where Ward boundaries are not available, these shall be obtained from the ULB authorities and arranged as per the prescribed schema (Letter No. XII-010/21/2023-Map/12 dated 16th July, 2025 (copy enclosed). Please refer to para 7 of Circular 1 for further details.

6. The verified working maps of Sub-district and ULBs received from concerned authorities need to be used for making updates if any as marked by the respective

Sub-district/ULB authorities. Special attention should be given to Ward boundaries of ULBs, which will be verified with the concerned ULBs to delineate Rural and Urban areas. In cases where revision of Ward boundaries has occurred after receipt of data, the revised boundaries must be obtained from the concerned ULBs. The Circular containing necessary instruction for incorporating final MDDS/Short Codes, Names in vernacular languages and preparation of maps for certification of Sub-district and ULB maps from concerned authorities will be issued at an appropriate time.

7. As the updated geo-spatial data of administrative boundaries shall be used as digital framework for creating Charges and then for delineating Houselisting Blocks, you are requested to take necessary steps, to expedite the above mapping activities and monitor them for timely completion of the tasks. Further, progress of work need to be shared on a monthly basis with Map Division, ORGI in respect of your DCO, and beginning with September 2025.

Narayanm 08/09/2025

(Mritunjay Kumar Narayan)
Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India

Encl:

1. Letter No. XII-010/21/2023-Map/12 dated 16th July, 2025.
2. Sample template I - Sub- District.
3. Sample template II – Urban Local Body (ULB).
4. Sample template III – Ward.

To:

All Directorates of Census Operations.

Copy to:

1. All Divisional Heads of ORGI.
2. PPS/PS to Addl. RG(S/SK)/DDG.
3. Guard File.